TABLE OF CONTENTS

Page

11. CULTURAL HERITAGE 11-1

11.1 Introduction 11-1
11.2 Environmental Legislation, Standards and Guidelines 11-1
11.3 Assessment Methodology 11-2
11.4 Project Background 11-3
11.5 Built Heritage Impact Assessment 11-12
11.6 Archaeological Impact Assessment 11-15
11.7 Conclusion 11-20
11.8 Bibliography 11-21

List of Figures

Figure 11.1	Project Boundary of Northern Metropolis Highway - San Tin Section
Figure 11.2	Geology of the Assessment Area
Figure 11.3	1960s Aerial Photo
Figure 11.4	2023 Aerial Photo
Figure 11.5	Past Archaeological Investigations at Ngau Tam Mei Site of Archaeological Interest
Figure 11.6	Location of Built Heritage
Figure 11.7	Locations of Test Pit and Auger Hole
Figure 11.8	Areas Confirmed with Archaeological Significance

List of Table

Table 11.1 Inventory of Built Heritage Located Within the Assessment Area for the CHIA
Table 11.2 Summary of Archaeological Field Survey Conducted under Licence No. 522
Table 11.3 Summary of Test Pit Locations

Appendices

Appendix 11.1	Built Heritage Recording Sheets
Appendix 11.2	Test Pit and Auger Hole Records

11. CULTURAL HERITAGE

11.1 Introduction

11.1.1.1 This section presents the Cultural Heritage Impact Assessment (CHIA) findings of the Project. The CHIA, which covers Built Heritage Impact Assessment (BHIA) and Archaeological Impact Assessment (AIA), has been conducted in accordance with the requirements given in Clause 3.5.11 and Appendix J of the EIA Study Brief (No. ESB-373/2025).

11.1.1.2 The assessment area for CHIA includes areas within 300m from the Project Boundary and its associated works. Built heritage and site(s) of archaeological interest within the 300m assessment area have been identified. The impacts resulting from the construction and operation of the Project on the identified built heritage and site(s) of archaeological interest have been assessed. Appropriate mitigation measures have been proposed to alleviate the impacts as necessary.

11.2 Environmental Legislation, Standards and Guidelines

11.2.1.1 Legislation, standards and guidelines relevant to the CHIA include the following:

- Environmental Impact Assessment Ordinance (EIAO) (Cap. 499);
- Technical Memorandum on Environmental Impact Assessment Process (EIAO-TM) Annexes 10 and 19; and
- Antiquities and Monuments Ordinance (A&MO) (Cap. 53).

Environmental Impact Assessment Ordinance (EIAO) (Cap. 499) and EIAO-TM Annexes 10 and 19

11.2.1.2 According to Schedule 1 of the EIAO, ***Site of Cultural Heritage*** refers to "an antiquity or monument, whether being a place, building, site or structure or a relic, as defined in the Antiquities and Monuments Ordinance (Cap. 53) and any place, building, site, or structure or a relic identified by the Antiquities and Monuments Office to be of archaeological, historical or palaeontological significance."[1]

11.2.1.3 Annexes 10 and 19 of EIAO-TM provide the criteria and guidelines for evaluating the impacts to Sites of Cultural Heritage. It is stated in Annex 10 that adverse impacts to Sites of Cultural Heritage shall be kept to an absolute minimum and that the general presumption of impact assessment shall be in favour of the protection and conservation of all Sites of Cultural Heritage. Annex 19 provides the commonly adopted approaches and methodologies for assessment of impact on Sites of Cultural Heritage.

Antiquities and Monuments Ordinance (A&MO) (Cap. 53)

11.2.1.4 The *Ordinance* provides the statutory framework for preservation of objects of historical, archaeological and paleontological interest and for matters ancillary thereto or connected therewith. The *Ordinance* contains the statutory procedures

[1] Hong Kong e-Legislation. *Cap. 499 Environmental Impact Assessment Ordinance*. Retrieved from https://www.elegislation.gov.hk/hk/cap499.

for the Declaration of Monuments. Under the *Ordinance*, a "monument" means a place, building, site or structure which is declared to be a monument, historical building or archaeological or paleontological site or structure under Section 3 of the *Ordinance*. Excavations carried out on building works, demolition and interference of a proposed monument or monument are prohibited except under permit under Section 6 of the *Ordinance*.

11.3 Assessment Methodology

11.3.1.1 Following the requirement in Clause 3.5.11 of the EIA Study Brief, the CHIA consists of a BHIA and an AIA. The assessment methodology for BHIA and AIA are described below.

Baseline Study for Cultural Heritage Impact Assessment

11.3.1.2 Based on paragraph 1 in the Appendix J of the Northern Metropolis Highway – San Tin Section EIA Study Brief (No. ESB-373/2025), a desktop review for CHIA has been conducted to:

(i) Compile an inventory on items as listed in (a) to (e) below, as published in the website of Antiquities and Monuments Office (AMO) (www.amo.gov.hk) and are within the assessment area for the CHIA; and

(a) List of declared monuments and proposed monuments, "Declared Monuments in Hong Kong (as at 10 October 2024)";

(b) List of graded historic buildings, "List of Graded Historic Buildings (as at 13 March 2025)";

(c) List of new items for grading assessment, "List of New Items for Grading Assessment with Assessment Results (as at 29 May 2025)";

(d) List of Sites of Archaeological Interest in Hong Kong, "List of Sites of Archaeological Interest in Hong Kong (as at Nov 2012)"; and

(e) List of Government historic sites identified by Antiquities and Monuments Office, "*Government Historic Sites Identified by AMO (as at May 2022)*".

(ii) Identify impacts on items (a) to (e) arising from the Project.

11.3.1.3 For built heritage, site visits were carried out in the assessment area in October and November 2025 to evaluate the current condition of built heritage identified in the baseline study.

11.3.1.4 For site(s) of archaeological interest, an archaeological survey had been conducted at Ngau Tam Mei Site of Archaeological Interest (SAI38) for this Project. A *Licence to Excavate and Search for Antiquities* (No. 522) was issued on 18th November 2025 by the Antiquities Authority to an archaeologist (Dr. Li Long Lam, hereafter known as the "licenced archaeologist). The licenced archaeologist had supervised the archaeological survey. Fieldwork and its preparation works commenced in November/December 2025 and has been completed in December 2025.

Built Heritage Impact Assessment

11.3.1.5 Based on the results of the baseline study and site visits, a built heritage impact assessment has been conducted on items as listed in **Section 11.3.1.2** (i) (a), (b), (c) and (e) above within the assessment area to determine whether the Project has resulted in impacts on those items. Efforts have been made to avoid or keep the impacts on the items as listed in **Section 11.3.1.1**(i) (a), (b), (c) and (e) above to the minimum. Protective/monitoring/mitigation measures would be recommended in accordance with the assessment results if necessary.

Archaeological Impact Assessment

11.3.1.6 Based on the results of the baseline study and archaeological survey, an archaeological impact assessment has been conducted on items as listed in **Section 11.3.1.2** (i) (d) above within the assessment area to determine and evaluate whether the Project and its associated works have resulted in impacts on those items. In case impact on archaeological heritage cannot be avoided, mitigation measures have been designed and recommended in this chapter.

11.4 Project Background

11.4.1.1 The Northern Metropolis Highway - San Tin Section is situated in the northeast of Yuen Long District. It is an approximately 9-kilometre-long carriageway stretching from Au Tau (凹頭) to Pak Shek Au (白石凹), connecting the Tin Shui Wai Section and Kwu Tung Section of NMH. The Project passes through areas near Ngau Tam Mei (牛潭尾) and San Tin (新田). It also leads to Kam Tin (錦田) by connecting with Tsing Long Highway (青朗公路). **Figure 11.1** presents the Project area and the 300m assessment area for CHIA.

11.4.1.2 This section presents the geographical, historical and archaeological information of the Project area and its 300m assessment area. For ease of discussion, the following sections are discussed according to the areas along the Project alignment from south to north, namely Au Tau, Ngau Tam Mei and San Tin.

Geographical and Geological Background

Physical Geography

11.4.1.3 The alignment begins at the interchange of Yuen Long Highway / Tsing Long Highway. It traverses low-lying areas near Au Tau and runs along the western foothill of Kai Kung Leng (雞公嶺) which separates the Kam Tin plain and Ngau Tam Mei river valley. The alignment continues to the north and passes through Ngau Tam Shan (牛潭山) and Ki Lun Shan (麒麟山). Eventually, it reaches Pak Shek Au in the North District.

- Au Tau

11.4.1.4 The alignment connects with the Tin Shui Wai Section at the mouth of the Kam Tin (錦田) plain where the Kam Tin River discharges into Deep Bay. The area is surrounded by a large area of fishponds in Nam Sang Wai and Au Tau to the west, the lower foothills of Kai Kung Leng to the east, and Kam Tin River and Ho Hok Shan (蠔殼山) to the south. The landscape along the alignment transitions from low-lying wetlands and river plains near Kam Tin River in the south to the hill slopes of Kai Kung Leng in the north.

11.4.1.5 The terrain in this section is predominantly flat lowland, particularly in the vicinity of Tung Shing Lei (東成里), Sha Po Tsuen (沙埔村) and Mo Fan Heung (模範鄉). These low-lying areas generally have terrestrial elevations ranging from approximately +2mPD to +27mPD, with gradients of <1° to about 15°. Towards the foothills of Kai Kung Leng and Ho Hok Shan, the terrain becomes uneven with elevations rising to over +160mPD and +80mPD respectively, and gradients exceeding 35° and 27° respectively.

- Ngau Tam Mei

11.4.1.6 The alignment proceeds along the northern hillslopes of Kai Kung Leng on the southern edge of the Ngau Tam Mei river valley. It passes through the low-lying areas near Ngau Tam Mei Water Treatment Works, then heads east into the hill ranges of Ngau Tam Shan.

11.4.1.7 The terrain in this section is primarily rugged and uneven with steeper slopes and higher elevations as the alignment moves into the hill ranges of Kai Kung Leng and Ngau Tam Shan. These hill ranges near the alignment raise to elevations between approximately +20mPD and +337mPD, with gradients ranging from about 10° to 38°. Nevertheless, low-lying fishponds and agricultural fields with gently sloping terrain can still be found in the Ngau Tam Mei river valley. These low-lying areas near the alignment are elevated between approximately +7mPD and +30mPD with gradient of <1° to about 10°.

- San Tin

11.4.1.8 The alignment continues northwards along the hill ranges of *Ki Lun Shan* before crossing Fanling Highway and finishing at Pak Shek Au. An interchange connecting to the San Tin river valley is proposed at Saddle Pass (麒麟山坳), which also slightly encroaches into Ki Lun Tsuen (麒麟村) to the east of the Saddle Pass.

11.4.1.9 The terrain in this section is hilly as the alignment traverses along the hill ridges of Ki Kun Shan, with the San Tin river valley to the west and Sheung Rue River valley to the east. The terrestrial elevation around Ki Lun Shan ranges between approximately +30mPD and +210mPD, while it drops to about +40mPD at Saddle Pass. The low-lying plains of the San Tin river valley around the vicinity of the alignment is elevated between approximately +12mPD and +35mPD, while those of Ki Lun Tsuen range between approximately +12mPD and +36mPD. Gradients of the low-lying plains are generally between <1° and 10°, whereas those of Ki Lun Shan vary between 10° and 38°.

11.4.1.10 The alignment ends at Pak Shek Au, which is a gap between Ki Lun Shan in the south and Mount Kirkpatrick and Tit Hang Shan (鐵坑山) in the north where the Fanling Highway is located. The elevation rises again to the north as the alignment approaches Mount Kirkpatrick and Tit Hang Shan. Elevations in areas north of Fanling Highway range roughly from +6mPD to +127mPD. Gradient of this section is roughly between <1° and 23° while slopes on Mount Kirkpatrick and Tit Hang Shan rises to over 30°.

Past Landscape Reconstruction

11.4.1.11 Past landscape before modern development can be revealed from geology[2]. Referring to **Figure 11.2**, the landscape of the Project is comprised of hill ranges, river valleys and coastal environment.

- Au Tau

11.4.1.12 The alignment begins at the mouth of Kam Tin river valley. The surrounding watershed, including Ho Hok Shan and Kai Kung Leng, are primarily composed of volcanic rocks (JTM) formed during the Upper Jurassic period. These bedrocks are covered by debris flow deposits (Qpd) formed during the Pleistocene along the hill slopes.

11.4.1.13 River running in the Kam Tin valleys during the Pleistocene formed the second river terrace, as characterised by terraced alluvium deposits (Qpa). The first river terrace was formed later during the Holocene due to a drop in sea level at around 6,000BP[3], as represented by the alluvium deposits (Qa). The edge between the offshore seabed of the Deep Bay and the first river terrace delineates the past coastline before modern urban development, evidenced by the presence of marine mud (QHH) and alluvium deposits (Qa) within the assessment area.

11.4.1.14 The geology of the alignment near Au Tau is largely composed of marine mud (QHH), reflecting a coastal environment. The geology is then transitioned to volcanic rocks (JTM), debris flow deposits (Qpd) and terraced alluvium deposits (Qpa) as the alignment approaches the foothills of Kai Kung Leng into a more terrestrial landscape.

- Ngau Tam Mei

11.4.1.15 The alignment near Ngau Tam Mei primarily traverses hilly terrain, passing through the slopes of Kai Kung Leng and Ngau Tam Shan. Same as Kai Kung Leng, Ngau Tam Shan is composed of volcanic rocks (JTM) formed during the Upper Jurassic period, while its hillslopes are formed by debris flow deposits (Qpd) formed during the Pleistocene.

11.4.1.16 The ridgelines of Kai Kung Leng and Ngau Tam Shan define the west-facing Ngau Tam Mei river valley. Evidence of river activity during the Pleistocene is seen in the terraced alluvium deposits (Qpa), which mark the second river terrace. The first river terrace formed during the Holocene when the sea level dropped at around 6,000BP, as indicated by the alluvium deposits (Qa).

11.4.1.17 As the alignment crosses the Ngau Tam Mei river valley near the hillslopes, the geology of the alignment here is dominated by volcanic rocks (JTM) and debris flow deposits (Qpd).

- San Tin

11.4.1.18 The alignment continues northward from Ngau Tam Shan to the hill ranges of Ki Lun Shan. Ki Lun Shan shares the same geological composition as Ngau Tam Shan and Kai Kung Leng. It was formed during Upper Jurassic period (JTM) as part of the Tai Mo Shan Formation with debris flow deposits (Qpd) as slopes.

[2] Geotechnical Control Office. (1988). *Hong Kong Geological Survey Sheet 2*. Government of Hong Kong.
[3] Fyfe, J. A et al. (2000). The Quaternary Geology of Hong Kong. Hong Kong: Civil Engineering Department.

Terraced alluvium (Qpa) and alluvium (Qa) can be found in the San Tin river valley and Ki Lun Tsuen which is flanked by Ki Lung Shan and Ngau Tam Shan.

11.4.1.19 The alignment ends at Pak Shek Au near Mount Kirkpatrick and Tit Hang Shan where it connects with the NMH Kwu Tung Section. Mount Kirkpatrick is formed by Upper Jurassic volcanic bedrocks (JTM) and Carboniferous sedimentary bedrocks (Cmp), while Tit Hang Shan is formed by Carboniferous sedimentary bedrocks (Cmp and Cts). Their slopes are formed by debris flow deposits (Qpd). Past river activities near Pak Shek Au are evident by the terraced alluvium (Qpa) and alluvium (Qa) deposits.

Human Geography – Village Settlement

- Au Tau

11.4.1.20 Areas near at the mouth of Kam Tin river valley and Fung Kat Heung (逢吉鄉) had traditionally been used as cultivation fields in the early 20th century[4]. Village settlements in this area are established relatively recent. Backed by the northern foothills of Ho Hok Shan, a neighbourhood named Tung Shing Lei was established between 1919 and 1935[5]. Other village settlements, including Fung Kat Heung, Mo Fan Heung and Wah Shing Village (華盛村), are located at the bottom of the southwest hillslopes of Kai Kung Leng.

- Ngau Tam Mei

11.4.1.21 Traditional and well-established villages, such as Pok Wai (墈圍), are located at the former coastline before modern development. The plains with the valley in Ngau Tam Mei used to be cultivated by the *Punti* (本地) people from San Tin [6].

11.4.1.22 In the early 20th century, *Hakka* people from *Boluo* (博羅), *Huizhou* (惠州) and *Dongguan* (東莞) in the Guangdong Province moved in and rented the lands from the *Punti* to establish settlements and agriculture activities [7]. More villages were established in the Ngau Tam Mei river valley between the late 19th century and mid-20th century, including Yau Tam Mei Tsuen (攸潭美村), San Wai Tsuen (新圍村) and Long Ha (朗廈). They generally occupied areas in the mouth of the Ngau Tam Mei river valley close to the coast[8]. In the 1960s, these settlements had expanded further to the east of the valley [9] [10].

11.4.1.23 Towards the 21st century, some of the village area along San Tin Highway have been redeveloped into modern low-density private housings.

[4] Lands Department. (1924). *1:14332, unknown flying height, H32-0013 [aerial photo]*. Lands Department.
[5] Antiquities Advisory Board. *Historic Building Appraisal – Lau Village House*. Retrieved from https://www.aab.gov.hk/filemanager/aab/common/historicbuilding/en/657_Appraisal_En.pdf.
[6] U.S.D. Antiquities and Monuments Section. (1987). *Survey on historical rural architecture in San Tin Area*. Hong Kong: Antiquities and Monuments Office.
[7] U.S.D. Antiquities and Monuments Section. (1987). *Survey on historical rural architecture in San Tin Area*. Hong Kong: Antiquities and Monuments Office.
[8] Lands Department. (1945). *1:12000, 20000 ft., 681_4-4137 [aerial photo]*. Lands Department.
[9] Lands Department. (1966). *1:4,800 Sht 92 [topographic map]*. Lands Department.
[10] Lands Department. (1967). *1:4,800 Sht 75 [topographic map]*. Lands Department.

- San Tin

11.4.1.24 Major village settlements near San Tin are generally located on low-lying areas in close proximity to Deep Bay near Castle Peak Road. The aerial photos and topographic maps between 1940s and 1970s [11] [12] showed that the land use in the east and west of Saddle Pass (currently known as Pang Loon Tei (彭龍地) and Ki Lun Tsuen) was largely agricultural fields and fishponds.

- Pak Shek Au

11.4.1.25 There is no prominent settlement in the surroundings of Pak Shek Au. The aerial photos between 1945 and 1954 [13] [14] showed that the land use in this area was mainly for agricultural purposes.

Human Geography – Modern Development

11.4.1.26 Castle Peak Road was constructed between 1911 and 1920. It is one of the main roads connecting Sham Shui Po (深水埗), Tuen Mun (屯門), Yuen Long (元朗) and Sheung Shui (上水). Other than this modern road, aerial photos between 1924 and 1956 show that there was no significant change to the settlement patterns and agricultural land use.

11.4.1.27 The landscape changed significantly in the 1960s (**Figure 11.3** refers). Houses were gradually seen occupying the once agricultural fields near Pak Shek Au[15], San Tin[16], Ngau Tam Mei valley[17] [18] and Fung Kat Heung[19]. At the same time, agricultural fields in San Tin, Ngau Tam Mei and the mud land to the west of Castle Peak Road near Fung Kat Heung were gradually replaced by fishponds since the late 1950s[20] and 1960s[21] [22].

11.4.1.28 Construction of San Tin Highway commenced in the late 1980s as part of the Route 9 in Hong Kong (also known as New Territories Circular Road)[23]. Upon the completion of San Tin Highway, the agricultural landscape in Kwu Tung, San Tin, Ngau Tam Mei and Fung Kat Heung has been largely transformed into factories, temporary storages and open carparks. San Tin Highway was connected to Yuen Long Highway at an interchange near Au Tau[24].

11.4.1.29 A series of civil engineering works were carried out since 1990s to improve the living environment in the areas, such as the straightening and deepening works of Kam Tin River channels[25], the construction of Tsing Long Highway in the late 1990s[26]

[11] Lands Department. (1945). *1:12000, 20000ft, 681_4-3115 [aerial photo]*. Lands Department.
[12] Lands Department. (1979). *1:8000, 4000ft, 26173 [aerial photo]*. Lands Department.
[13] Lands Department. (1945). *1:12000, 20000ft, 681_4-3074 [aerial photo]*. Lands Department.
[14] Lands Department. (1954). *1:25029, 29200ft, V81A_550-0047R [aerial photo]*. Lands Department.
[15] Lands Department. (1961). *1:10000, 30000ft, F41_625-0026 [aerial photo]*. Lands Department.
[16] Lands Department. (1964). *1:25000, 12500ft, 1964-2788 [aerial photo]*. Lands Department.
[17] Lands Department. (1961). *1:10000, 30000ft, F42_625-0022 [aerial photo]*. Lands Department.
[18] Lands Department. (1961). *1:10000, 30000ft, F42_625-0020 [aerial photo]*. Lands Department.
[19] Lands Department. (1961). *1:10000, 30000ft, F43_625-0019 [aerial photo]*. Lands Department.
[20] Lands Department. (1956). *1:10020, 16700 ft. F22_560-0205* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.
[21] Lands Department. (1963). *1:27000, 13500 ft., V81A_857-0013R* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.
[22] Lands Department. (1975). *1:25000, 12500ft, 11882R* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.
[23] Lands Department. (1988). *1:8000, 4000ft., A15814* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.
[24] Lands Department. (1990). *1:4000, 2000 ft., A21941 [aerial photo]*. Lands Department.
[25] Drainage Services Department (2022). *Shan Pui River / Kam Tin River*. Retrieved from https://www.dsd.gov.hk/EcoDMS/EN/River_Channels/Shan_Pui_River.html#.
[26] Lands Department (1996). *1:8000 4000 ft. A44200, [aerial photo]*. Lands Department.

and commission of Ngau Tam Mei Water Treatment Works in 2000[27] (**Figure 11.4** refers).

11.4.1.30 In 2007, urban development plans in North East New Territories New Development Area were initiated[28]. In light of the scheduled developments in Kwu Tung North New Development Area[29], infrastructure and site formation works have been taken places in Kwu Tung, particularly in areas to the north of Fanling Highway, since the 2020s[30].

Historical Background

Qin to Yuan Dynasties (221BC to AD1368)

11.4.1.31 Clues of human occupation within the south China can be found in historic textual records such as *Shiji* (史記) and *Hanshu* (漢書), written in the first century BC and first century AD respectively. These records describe that *Yue* ethnic groups (also known as *Hundreds of Yue* (百越)) were scattered in southern China. The *Yue* ethnic groups were comprised of different tribes bearing various surnames and can be differentiated from the *Han* ethnic group who lived in central China in terms of physical characteristics, language, and folklore.

11.4.1.32 The *Yue* people were gradually assimilated into the *Han* culture when southern China became an administration territory of the central government since *Qin* dynasty (221BC to 206BC). During the *Qin* period, the *Guangdong* region was subordinated to *Panyu* (番禺) County. In 208BC, *Southern Yue* State (南越國) was established around the *Guangdong* region by military officials, who were sent from the *Qin* Court to conquer the *Yue* in the south. Following the collapse of *Qin*'s political power in the north, *Han* dynasty (206BC to AD220)[31] began. *Southern Yue* State was soon becoming a vassal state of Han before integrated into the *Han* Empire.

11.4.1.33 Between *Han* and *Eastern Jin* dynasties (AD317 to AD420), Hong Kong was subordinated to *Boluo* (博羅) County[32]. From AD331 to AD756, Hong Kong was subordinated to *Bao'an* (寶安) County. After AD757, Hong Kong was subordinated to *Dongguan* (東莞) County and followed by *Song* dynasty (AD960 to AD1279) and *Yuan* dynasty (AD1271 to AD1368)[33].

Ming to Qing Dynasties (1368 to 1912)

11.4.1.34 During the 15th century, the coastal areas of *Dongguan* County suffered from frequent marauding bandit and pirate attacks. *Xin'an* (新安) County was thus set

[27] Water Supplies Department. *Ngau Tam Mei Water Treatment Works*. Retrieved from https://www.wsd.gov.hk/filemanager/en/share/pdf/NgauTamMeiTW-e.pdf.
[28] Development Bureau (2025). *The New Development Areas – Introduction/Background*. Retrieved from https://www.ktnfln-ndas.gov.hk/en/2-1-about_project.php.
[29] Civil Engineering and Development Department. *Major Projects - Advance Site Formation and Engineering Infrastructure Works at Kwu Tung North and Fanling North New Development Area*. Retrieved from https://www.cedd.gov.hk/eng/our-projects/major-projects/index-id-36.html.
[30] Lands Department. (2020). *1:10000, 6900ft, E093012 [aerial photo].* Lands Department.
[31] 司馬遷 (c.a. 91BC)。史記 卷一百一十三 南越列傳 第五十三。北京：中華書局 (1959) 。
[32] Although the boundary between Boluo (博羅) County and Panyu (番禺) County during Han to East Jin period is unclear, it is generally suggested that Hong Kong region belonged to Boluo County at that time, according to Xinan Gazetteer (1819), Social Change in Hong Kong Before and After the Early Qing Clearance (1986), and Brief History of Ancient Shenzhen (1997). However, Professor Jao Tsung-I (2005) discussed that the area belonged to Panyu based on the inscriptions on bricks of Lei Cheng Uk Han Tomb.
[33] 劉智鵬、劉蜀永 (編) (2020) 《方志中的古代香港-《新安縣志》香港史料選》。香港，三聯書店（香港）有限公司。

up in 1573 to defend such attacks. According to *Xin'an Gazetteer* (新安縣誌)[34], the modern region of Hong Kong fell within the *Xin'an* County.

11.4.1.35 In 1661, Coastal Evacuation Order was compelled by the *Qing* Court to stifle the anti-Manchu troops in Taiwan. People living in coastal area were forced to move 50 *li* (里) (approximately 25 km) inland, including the New Territories inhabitants. The Order was lifted in 1669. However, after the coastal evacuation, population dropped severely. During the *Shunzhi* reign (1643-1661), the population of *Xin'an* County was recorded as six thousand eight hundred and eighty-one (6,851). The population dropped to two thousand one hundred and seventy-two (2,172) in 1664 during the enforcement of the Order. After the Order was lifted, people were encouraged to move back to *Xin'an* County during the late 17th to early 18th centuries. In 1671, the population increased to three thousand nine hundred and seventy-two (3,972), one thousand six hundred and forty-eight (1,648) people were encouraged to move back during 1669 to 1671[35].

11.4.1.36 After the First Opium War (1839 to 1842) between the *Qing* government and the British Empire, the Qing government "…ceded … the Island of Hongkong, to be possessed in perpetuity by … Great Britain" signed in 1842 under the *Treaty of Peace, Friendship, Commerce, Indemnity, etc., Between Great Britain and China* (also known as the *Treaty of Nanking* (南京條約))[36]. The *Qing* government lost the Second Opium War (1856 to 1860), which led to the ceding Kowloon as a dependency of Hong Kong under the *Convention of Peace and Friendship Between Great Britain and China*[37] (also known as the *Convention of Peking* (北京條約)) in 1860. At the turn of the 20th century, *the Convention between Great Britain and China Respecting an Extension of Hong Kong Territory* (also known as the *Second Convention of Peking* (第二北京條約)) signed between the British and the Qing government in 1898 allowed the British colony to "… enlarged under lease … [for] ninety-nine years." [38]

11.4.1.37 In the 19th century, more villages were established near Ngau Tam Mei, such as Pok Wai and Yau Tam Mei Tsuen. These villages were occupied by different surnames.

11.4.1.38 Pok Wai was a multi-clan walled village. The exact year of establishment is unknown. Based on the inscription on a memorial tablet in the village temple, it is speculated the village was about a century ago (19th century). The *Ngs*, the *Mans* and the *Fungs* were the three dominant clans in the village[39].

11.4.1.39 Yau Tam Mei Tsuen ("攸潭美村") was originally named Ngau Tam Mei Tsuen ("牛潭美村"). It was renamed as Yau Tam Mei since the villagers find the word "牛" (literally mean "cow") distasteful40 . In the 19th century, the Chows moved from Boluo (博羅) of Guangdong (廣東) province to the village. They established Wai

[34] 劉智鵬、劉蜀永 (編) (2020) 《方志中的古代香港-《新安縣志》香港史料選》。香港，三聯書店（香港）有限公司。
[35] 靳文謨修、鄧文蔚纂 (1688) 。新安縣志。在廣東省地方志辦公室編，廣東歷代方志集成：廣州府部（二六）[康熙]新安縣志 [嘉慶]新安縣志。廣東：嶺南美術出版社。
[36] Hong Kong Government. (1964). *Laws of Hong Kong. Appendix IV A Selection of Constitutional Documents, Conventions and Treaties*. Retrieved from https://oelawhk.lib.hku.hk/archive/files/87f64e08aedf20f07b7d8ac2132030c1.pdf.
[37] Ibid.
[38] Ibid.
[39] U.S.D. Antiquities and Monuments Section. (1987). *Survey on historical rural architecture in San Tin Area*. Hong Kong: Antiquities and Monuments Office.
[40] 陳六霞、洪小麗 (1985)。田野工作報告 – 新田區總報告。

Cheung Ancestral Hall in 1887 to commemorate their ancestor Chow Wai-cheung (周維祥) in 1887. The village was also inhabited with the Lau and Chu clan.

Modern Period (After 1912)

11.4.1.40 New villages were established and developed in the 20th century around the Project area, including Fung Kat Heung, San Wai Tsuen, Mo Fan Heung and Wah Shing Tsuen. These villages were generally multi-clan villages.

11.4.1.41 San Wai Tsuen was originally occupied by the *Wongs* since the early 20th century, but then abandoned for a period of time[41]. In the late Qing and early Republican period, the area was revitalised and occupied by the *Yeungs* from *Toishan* (台山) and *Siyi* (四邑). The *Yeungs* named the village as "Fuk Hing Lane (福慶里)", but the village was also known as San Wai (新圍) or San Wai Tsai (新圍仔)[42]. The *Yeungs* were later joined by the *Lees*, the *Wongs*, the *Tongs*, the *Yans* and the *Chans*[43] [44].

11.4.1.42 Fung Kat Heung was established and inhabited by *Shum Hung-ying* (沈鴻英), a well-known warlord during the warlord period of the Republic of China. He fled to Hong Kong after losing the battle[45]. *Shum Hung-ying* constructed his residence in 1932 and named the location of his residence as "逢吉鄉" (literally means Village of Meeting Luck)[46].

11.4.1.43 Mo Fan Heung was probably originated from a property development plan named "Model Chinese Village" in the 1920s[47]. However, no housing estates could be observed in the aerial photos taken in 1949 [48], hinting that such property development had not been fully implemented. Nevertheless, the name has retained for the area. According to the old topographic map[49], the village was labelled as "*Wa Yan Mo Fan Tsue*n" (probably the Cantonese romanisation of "華人模範村", meaning "Chinese Model Village"). Developments in Mo Fan Heung could only be observed after 1950[50].

11.4.1.44 No major historic event was recorded in the area until the World War II. On 8th December 1941, the Japanese troops invaded Hong Kong from the north across the border. The troops had travelled via Castle Peak Road from Lok Ma Chau to Yuen Long and Kowloon. They passed through Ngau Tam Mei and Fung Kat Heung from 8th to 9th December 1941[51].

11.4.1.45 After World War II, Tam Mei Barracks and San Tin Barracks were constructed no later than 1952[52]. Aerial photos from 1954 reveal the presence of trenches and jeep

[41] 陳六霞、洪小麗 (1985)。田野工作報告 – 新田區總報告。
[42] *Ibid*.
[43] *Ibid*.
[44] U.S.D. Antiquities and Monuments Section. (1987). *Survey on historical rural architecture in San Tin Area*. Hong Kong: Antiquities and Monuments Office.
[45] Antiquities Advisory Board. *Historic Building Appraisal - General House – Main Building, Fung Kat Heung, Yuen Long*. Retrieved from https://www.aab.gov.hk/filemanager/aab/common/historicbuilding/en/307_Appraisal_En.pdf.
[46] 黃佩佳（2017）。香港本地風光・附新界百詠。香港:商務印書館（香港）有限公司。
[47] Novel Scheme – Proposed $200,000 Model Village (1925, April 16). The China Mail, p. 1.
[48] Lands Department (1949). *1:4800, 8000ft, 81A_124-6029 [aerial photo].* Lands Department.
[49] Lands Department (1962). *1:1200 91-SE-B [topographic map].* Lands Department.
[50] Lands Department (1954). *1:25029 29200 ft. V81A_550-0078, [aerial photo].* Lands Department.
[51] History in Data Project website (Accessed on 17 March 2025) Hong Kong 1941. Retrieved from https://digital.lib.hkbu.edu.hk/1941hkbattle/en/research-team.php.
[52] Great Britain. War Office. General Staff. Geographical Section & Great Britain. Ordnance Survey. (1952). *Hong Kong and New Territory, Sheet 10 San Tin (Fifth Edition)*. Retrieved from http://nla.gov.au/nla.obj-2975836020.

tracks at Ngau Tam Shan[53], suggesting that military activities were conducted at Ngau Tam Shan from the 1950s onwards. Old newspaper in 1965 also recorded that military facilities such as trenches and snake fences were installed on Ngau Tam Shan for defence purpose, yet they were abandoned and lack of maintenance[54].

11.4.1.46 Meanwhile, new villages were established at the western foothills of Kai Kung Leng, including Long Ha and Wah Shing Village. For Long Ha, the earliest structure in the village of Long Ha was Chan Ming Yam Tong (陳明任堂), which was built no later than 1945[55]. Clusters of houses could be identified in the 1963 aerial photos, showing that the area evolved into a residential area in the 1960s[56]. According to the couplet of the Chan Ming Yam Tong, the building is associated to the *Chan* clan from *Taishan*. The settlers in Long Ha were probably associated to this branch of *Chan* clan.

11.4.1.47 Wah Shing Village was established in 1966 for the victims of typhoons and other natural disasters in the New Territories[57]. It was built with the donations from the American churches and was named after Herman A. Washington, who was “a good and loyal friend of Hong Kong” according to the inscriptions on a marble memorial tablet in the village.

Archaeological Background

Site of Archaeological Interest (SAI)

- Ngau Tam Mei Site of Archaeological Interest

11.4.1.48 Ngau Tam Mei Site of Archaeological Interest (SAI38) is partly within the Project Boundary (**Figure 11.5** refers). During the *1997 Territorial-Wide Archaeological Survey in Yuen Long*[58], significant findings were reported at the site. Pottery shards featuring distinctive "Union Jack" patterns, which have been dated to the Bronze Age, were found. These findings suggested human habitation in the area from the Bronze Age. The site was later recognised as Ngau Tam Mei SAI.

11.4.1.49 An archaeological survey was conducted in 1999 for the construction of channelised nullah in NTM[59]. Under this investigation, twelve (12) augur holes tests and three (3) trenches were carried out in the vicinity of the Ngau Tam Mei SAI to demark the boundary of the SAI (**Figure 11.5** refers). Pottery sherds and tiles dated between the late Bronze Age and the Han dynasty were found on the surface of the SAI, but no relics were discovered from the auger holes and trenches. This suggested that the archaeological potential is unlikely to spread into the study area of the nullah project.

[53] Lands Department. (1954). *1:25 029 29200ft, V81A_550-0076 [aerial photo]*. Survey and Mapping Office, Lands Department
[54] 八鄉打石湖一帶 夜聞虎嘯 驚動軍警循聲往捕 通山搜索又無所得 (1965年8月4日)。華僑日報，第二張第一頁。
[55] Lands Department. (1945). *1:12000, 20000 ft., 681_4-4137 [aerial photo].* Lands Department.
[56] Lands Department (1963). *1:1000, T2-SE-21D [digital orthophoto].* Lands Department.
[57] 錦田逢吉鄉 興建華盛頓新邨 下月十一日開幕 為新界遭受風災災民而建 (1966年2月27日)。華僑日報，第三張第三頁。
[58] 古物古蹟辦事處 (1997) 。《全港文物普查1997第一地區(元朗區)工作報告》。香港：古物古蹟辦事處檔案。
[59] 古物古蹟辦事處 (1999) 。《元朗牛潭尾主渠道第二期工程考古調查工作報告》。香港：古物古蹟辦事處檔案。

11.5 Built Heritage Impact Assessment

Introduction

11.5.1.1 As mentioned in **Section 11.3**, the Appendix J of the EIA Study Brief (No. ESB-373/2025) stated that "*The Applicant shall conduct a built heritage impact assessment on items as listed in paragraph 1 (i)* [**Section 11.3.1.2** (i)] *(a), (b), (c) and (e) above within the assessment area to determine whether the Project will result in impacts on those items.*" Therefore, the BHIA has been conducted to compile an inventory of items listed in the specified resources that are within the assessment area for the CHIA and identify impacts on them arising from the Project. The items to be assessed in the BHIA exclusively include the following:

(i) Items included in the list of declared monuments and proposed monuments, "*Declared Monuments in Hong Kong (as at 10 October 2024)*";

(ii) Items included in the list of graded historic buildings, "*List of Graded Historic Buildings (as at 13 March 2025)*";

(iii) Items included in the list of new items for grading assessment, "List of New Items for Grading Assessment with Assessment Results (as at 29 May 2025)"; and

(iv) Items included in the list of Government historic sites identified by Antiquities and Monuments Office, "*Government Historic Sites Identified by AMO (as at May 2022)*".

Baseline Study

11.5.1.2 No declared monument, proposed monument, new item for grading assessment and Government historic site identified by AMO listed in the resources in **Section 11.5.1.1** is located within the assessment area.

11.5.1.3 Five (5) grade 2 historic buildings and eight (8) grade 3 historic buildings are located within the assessment area of 300m from the Project Boundary (**Table 11.1** refers). Their locations are shown in **Figure 11.6**. Details of these built heritages are presented in **Appendix 11.1 Built Heritage Recording Sheets**.

Table 11.1 Inventory of Built Heritage Located Within the Assessment Area for the CHIA

Index	Item	Status	Approximate Distance to Project Boundary (in metres)	Details and Photographic Record
HB312	Lady Ho Tung Welfare Centre, Main Block, No. 38 Kwu Tung Road, Sheung Shui, N.T.	Grade 2 Historic Building	104m	Built Heritage Recording Sheet No. 1
HB313	Lady Ho Tung Welfare Centre, Bungalow, No. 38 Kwu Tung Road, Sheung Shui, N.T.	Grade 2 Historic Building	128m	Built Heritage Recording Sheet No. 1

Index	Item	Status	Approximate Distance to Project Boundary (in metres)	Details and Photographic Record
HB307	General House, Main Building, Fung Kat Heung, Yuen Long, N.T.	Grade 2 Historic Building	109m	Built Heritage Recording Sheet No. 2
HB355	General House, Hip Wai House, Fung Kat Heung, Yuen Long, N.T.	Grade 2 Historic Building	128m	Built Heritage Recording Sheet No. 2
HB405	General House, Shum Ancestral Hall, Fung Kat Heung, Yuen Long, N.T.	Grade 2 Historic Building	104m	Built Heritage Recording Sheet No. 2
HB604	Manor House, Kwu Tung, Sheung Shui, N.T.	Grade 3 Historic Building	246m	Built Heritage Recording Sheet No. 3
HB618	Lau Village House, Hak Sut Tong, No. 68 Tung Shing Lei, Au Tau, Yuen Long, N.T.	Grade 3 Historic Building	197m	Built Heritage Recording Sheet No. 4
HB642	Lau Village House, No. 65 Tung Shing Lei, Au Tau, Yuen Long, N.T.	Grade 3 Historic Building	230m	Built Heritage Recording Sheet No. 5
HB643	Lau Village House, No. 66 Tung Shing Lei, Au Tau, Yuen Long, N.T.	Grade 3 Historic Building	221m	Built Heritage Recording Sheet No. 5
HB644	Lau Village House, No. 67 Tung Shing Lei, Au Tau, Yuen Long, N.T.	Grade 3 Historic Building	211m	Built Heritage Recording Sheet No. 5
HB657	Lau Village House, No. 63 Tung Shing Lei, Au Tau, Yuen Long, N.T.	Grade 3 Historic Building	241m	Built Heritage Recording Sheet No. 5
HB784	No. 71 San Wai Tsuen, San Tin, Yuen Long, N.T.	Grade 3 Historic Building	260m	Built Heritage Recording Sheet No. 6
HB858	No. 70 San Wai Tsuen, San Tin, Yuen Long, N.T.	Grade 3 Historic Building	277m	Built Heritage Recording Sheet No. 7

Identification and Evaluation of Impacts

Construction Phase

11.5.1.4 All the identified built heritage, including five (5) grade 2 historic buildings and eight (8) grade 3 historic buildings, are situated at a considerable distance from the Project Boundary. Therefore, no impact to built heritage is anticipated by the Project and its associated works during the construction phase.

Operation Phase

11.5.1.5 No impact is anticipated by the Project during the operation phase to all the identified built heritage.

Mitigation Measures

Construction Phase

11.5.1.6 As no impact to all the identified built heritage is anticipated during the construction phase, no mitigation measure is therefore required.

Operation Phase

11.5.1.7 As no impact to all the identified built heritage is anticipated during the operation phase, no mitigation measure is therefore required.

Environmental Monitoring and Audit

11.5.1.8 As no impact to all the identified built heritage is anticipated during the construction phase, no environmental monitoring and audit is therefore required.

Summary

11.5.1.9 The baseline study, comprising desktop research and field evaluation, has identified thirteen (13) graded historic buildings within the assessment area of the Project but outside the Project Boundary. The five (5) Grade 2 historic buildings and eight (8) Grade 3 historic buildings are situated at a considerable distance from the Project Boundary. Therefore, no impact to them during the construction and operation phases.

11.5.1.10 No declared monument, proposed monument, new item for grading assessment and Government historic site is located within the assessment area. Therefore, no impact is anticipated to the built heritage during the construction and operation phases.

11.5.1.11 As no impact on built heritage is anticipated during the construction and operation phases, no mitigation measure is required.

11.6 Archaeological Impact Assessment

Introduction

11.6.1.1 As mentioned in **Section 11.3**, the Appendix J of the EIA Study Brief (No. ESB-373/2025) stated that "*The Applicant shall conduct an archaeological impact assessment on items as listed in paragraph 1(i) (d) above within the assessment area to determine whether the Project will result in impacts on those items.*" Therefore, the AIA has been conducted to compile an inventory of items listed in the specified resources that are within the assessment area for the archaeological impact and identify impacts on them arising from the Project. The items to be assessed in the AIA exclusively include the following:

- Items included in the list of Sites of Archaeological Interest in Hong Kong, "*List of Sites of Archaeological Interest in Hong Kong (as at Nov 2012)*".

Archaeological Field Survey

Approach and Methodology of Archaeological Survey

11.6.1.2 One (1) Site of Archaeological Interest (SAI), namely Ngau Tam Mei SAI (SAI38) is located within the assessment area and it is partly located within the Project Boundary.

11.6.1.3 An archaeological field survey and its preparation works for the Archaeological Impact Assessment (AIA) was commenced on 20 November 2025 and has been completed on 15 December 2025. The archaeological field survey was conducted before the land resumption process. Due to land status constraints, the survey was confined to those accessible areas within the Project Boundary, at the time of the licence application, that encroached into the Ngau Tam Mei SAI. As such, the two (2) test pits and two (2) auger holes, along with field scanning were allocated and excavated within the Ngau Tam Mei SAI (**Table 11.2** refers).

Table 11.2 Summary of Archaeological Field Survey Conducted under Licence No. 522

Concerned Area	Archaeological Works Completed Under the Licence	Figure No.
Ngau Tam Mei SAI	• 2 test pits (NTM-TP1, NTM-TP2) • 2 auger holes • Field scanning	**Figure 11.7**

11.6.1.4 The land use and geology of the actual test pits conducted in Ngau Tam Mei SAI is shown in **Table 11.3**.

Table 11.3 Summary of Test Pit Locations

Test Pit No.	Concerned Location	
	Land use	Solid / Superficial Geology
NTM-TP1	Abandoned Land	JTM
NTM-TP2	Abandoned Land	Qpd

Summary and Interpretation of Archaeological Field Survey Results

Test Pit Excavation

11.6.1.5 Two (2) test pits and two (2) auger holes, along with field scanning were conducted at Ngau Tam Mei SAI. The test pit excavations aimed to establish the horizontal spread of cultural layers and the depth of cultural layers (if any), as well as to discover the presence of any buried archaeological remains. The test pits were excavated with dimensions of 2.0m by 1.0m with vertical test pit walls and rectangular shape in plan. The locations of the two test pits, namely NTM-TP1 and NTM-TP2 (where NTM and TP stand for "Ngau Tam Mei SAI" and "Test Pit", respectively), are shown in **Figure 11.7**.

11.6.1.6 Both test pits were placed to ensure the archaeological significance could be discerned from the proposed location. Test pits were placed in a North-South orientation to facilitate field recording. Excavation of NTM-TP1 was carried out using hand-held tools and extended down to the sterile layer. Hand-held auger hole drilling was performed on NTM-TP1 upon reaching the bottom of the test pit and in proximity to verify that the excavation reached the sterile layer. Attempts were made to excavate NTM-TP2, but since there was a concrete surface exposed after removing the top soil, in-depth excavation and augering were interrupted.

11.6.1.7 No artefact was identified in both NTM-TP1 and NTM-TP2. Stratigraphy and record for the concerned test pits and auger holes are presented in **Appendix 11.2 Test Pit and Auger Hole Records**. The findings of the two test pits are discussed below.

Findings from NTM-TP1 and NTM-TP2

11.6.1.8 NTM-TP1 was located on the gentle slope in front of *Sun Hing Farm* (新興農場), while NTM-TP2 was located in adjacent to the concrete road connecting to the farm.

11.6.1.9 NTM-TP1 consisted of two (2) major strata in five (5) contexts, reflecting the natural and human events that took place in this area. NTM-AH1 (AH stands for "Auger Hole") was drilled in proximity to a depth of 1.2 m that showed an identical context. An auger hole was also drilled at the base of NTM-TP1 further down 0.43 m at a depth of 1.63 m when it encountered rocks.

- Context NTM-TP1-C1 to NTM-TP1-C4: Modern deposit
  - No artefacts were identified in this stratum;
  - NTM-TP1-C1 was modern fill soil that contained frequent refuse and humus;
  - NTM-TP1-C2 was modern agricultural soil containing frequent roots;
  - NTM-TP1-C3 was modern agricultural soil that contained occasional weathered rocks.; and
  - NTM-TP1-C4 is a cut likely showing a dug pit of Context NTM-TP1-C3 could be observed at the south profile in this context.

- Context NTM-TP1-C5: Sterile. The test pit ended at 1.2 m depth, and auger hole drilling revealed the same deposit as Context NTM-AH1-C4.
  - No artefacts were identified in this stratum; and
  - NTM-TP1-C5 was a firm dark brown silty clay that contained occasional weathered rocks. It represented the slope deposit of colluvial soil commonly seen in this region. This context was also the limit of excavation.

11.6.1.10 NTM-TP2 consisted of one (1) major stratum in two (2) contexts, reflecting the human events that took place in this area. The test pit encountered a concrete surface at a depth of 0.14 m and could not proceed further to reach the sterile layer. NTM-AH2 was drilled in proximity to a depth of 0.1 m that showed an identical context.

- Context NTM-TP2-C1 to NTM-TP2-C2: Modern deposit
  - No artefacts were identified in this stratum;
  - NTM-TP2-C1 was modern fill soil that contained moderate roots and concrete; and
  - NTM-TP2-C2 was an indurated concrete surface that spread across the test pit. This context was also the limit of excavation.

Interpretation of the Test Pit Excavation Data

NTM-TP1

11.6.1.11 The modern deposits identified in these two test pits (i.e. NTM-TP1 and NTM-TP2) revealed that the area has been disturbed by the continued establishment of *Sun Hing Farm* since the early 20th century. NTM-TP1 revealed modern deposit with a depth of approximately 0.8m (i.e. Context NTM-TP1-C1 to NTM-TP1-C3), as told by the owner of *Sun Hing Farm* that refuse and fill soil were once disposed at such location. The excavation of the test pit showed that modern agricultural activities had taken place, with occasional roots observed since Context NTM-TP1-C3. A dug pit (i.e. Context NTM-TP1-C4 (Cut)) appeared as U-shape in the south profile during the formation of Context NTM-TP1-C3 and breaking over the sterile layer Context NTM-TP1-C4, suggesting that soil ploughing had likely occurred at this location. The soil profile of Context NTM-TP1-C3 likely indicated that the agricultural fields were extracted and transferred from slope deposit of colluvial soil in other locations and disposed, placing on top of the sterile layer. Such agricultural activities were evident in aerial photos from the 1960s [60]. After the abandonment of agriculture, the surrounding environment suggested the location was converted to fruit trees planting, forming Context NTM-TP1-C2 that contained frequent roots. In the 1980s, with the construction of a footpath connecting to the entrance of *Sun Hing Farm*, a certain agricultural field had been removed and levelled [61]. It led to the formation of the modern fill soil as seen in Context NTM-TP1-C1, with frequent refuse and humus containing as an abandoned land.

11.6.1.12 This reconstruction of the chronological sequence of the stratigraphy in NTM-TP1 suggested that the location possesses low archaeological significance. (**Figure 11.8** refers) The lack of archaeological materials and notable cultural layers in NTM-TP1 supported this notion.

NTM-TP2

11.6.1.13 NTM-TP2, on the other hand, revealed the construction of a footpath connecting to the *Sun Hing Farm* since the 1980s [62]. A concrete surface was constructed on the

[60] Lands Department. (1963). *1:27000, 13500 ft., V81A_857-0013R [aerial photo]*. Lands Department.
[61] Lands Department. (1988). *1:8000, 4000ft., A15814 [aerial photo]*. Lands Department.
[62] *Ibid.*

footpath to strengthen the road structure, as it reflected in Context NTM-TP2-C2. Context NTM-TP2-C1 was modern fill soil that served as an abandon land adjacent to the connecting road, where it contained grass roots and concrete pieces. With reference to aerial photos, the location of NTM-TP2 was previously agricultural fields.

11.6.1.14 The archaeological field survey conducted for this AIA only identified Context NTM-TP2-C1 as modern fill overlying the concrete surface of Context NTM-TP2-C2. The existing concrete surface hindered further excavation. Archaeological deposits (if any) potentially underlying the concrete surface could not be investigated at the current stage.

Licence Area Adopted for AIA and its Applicability

11.6.1.15 To obtain solid archaeological information on the tentative Project area which has partly been surveyed before and facilitate the design of Northern Metropolis Highway - San Tin Section, this archaeological field survey was conducted before finalisation of the Project design and land resumption arrangements.

11.6.1.16 The Licence Area for this archaeological field survey was based on the tentative Project area at the time of the licence application, with the selection of test pit and auger hole locations primarily constrained by land status considerations. As a result, only accessible areas could be surveyed within the Ngau Tam Mei SAI at this stage. Subsequent refinement to the Project design was proposed, resulting in an expansion of the Project Boundary to encompass a larger portion of the Ngau Tam Mei SAI. The Licence Area at Ngau Tam Mei SAI, the locations of test pit and auger holes, as well as the latest Project Boundary are shown in **Figure 11.7**.

11.6.1.17 Notwithstanding the refinement of the Project Boundary, all archaeological fieldwork locations within the Ngau Tam Mei SAI remain within the latest Project Boundary. The archaeological survey was undertaken on accessible natural terrains with the objective of obtaining useful archaeological information. In particular, NTM-TP1 was excavated to the sterile layer, providing clear evidence of past human activities. Therefore, the data retrieved from the archaeological fieldwork remain applicable and sufficient for analysing the archaeological significance of the surveyed area within the Ngau Tam Mei SAI.

Identification and Evaluation of Impacts

Construction Phase

11.6.1.18 The Ngau Tam Mei SAI is partially located within the Project Boundary but outside the proposed alignment. According to the latest construction works arrangement, the works that will be carried out within the SAI would only be those temporary works (such as filling up the area for haul road use) that are non-intrusive in nature and would cause no sub-soil disturbance. Moreover, the methodology proposed for such works are reversible and the ground conditions will be reinstated upon construction of works. Therefore, no impact to the SAI is anticipated.

Operation Phase

11.6.1.19 No impact on archaeology is anticipated during the operation phase of the Project since any archaeological impact, if any, would have been mitigated before or during the construction phase.

Mitigation Measures

Construction Phase

11.6.1.20 As no impact to the Ngau Tam Mei SAI is anticipated, no mitigation measure is required. As control measures, the contractor should submit a method statement for the installation and removal of temporary works within the Ngau Tam Mei SAI for agreement with AMO. The works must ensure that no disturbance to the soil matrix at the Ngau Tam Mei SAI. Photographic records of the ground condition should be taken before the execution of any works, after all works have been removed from the zone, as well as at intervals during the construction phase and submitted to AMO for retention.

11.6.1.21 Pursuant to the A&MO (Cap. 53), the project proponent is required to inform AMO immediately in case of discovery of antiquities or supposed antiquities in the course of works, so that appropriate mitigation measures, if needed, can be formulated in a timely manner and implemented in agreement with and to the satisfaction of AMO.

Operation Phase

11.6.1.22 No impact to archaeology is anticipated during the operational phase as archaeological impact, if any, would have been mitigated before or during the construction phase. Hence no mitigation measure is required.

Environmental Monitoring and Audit

11.6.1.23 The contractor should submit a method statement for the installation and removal of the temporary works within the Ngau Tam Mei SAI for AMO's agreement. Photographic records of the ground condition within the SAI should be taken before the execution of any works, after all works have been removed from the zone, as well as at intervals during the construction phase and submitted to AMO for retention.

11.6.1.24 According to the latest construction works arrangement, the works to be carried out within the Ngau Tam Mei SAI would only be those temporary works that are non-intrusive in nature and would cause no sub-soil disturbance. However, if the arrangement deviates from the current proposed situations, an archaeological survey-cum-excavation should be carried out to obtain archaeological data for assessing the impact before commencement of the works, in consultation with the AMO, and to design mitigation measure as appropriate.

11.6.1.25 Pursuant to the A&MO, the project proponent is required to inform AMO immediately in case of discovery of antiquities or supposed antiquities in the course of works. Details of the EM&A requirements are provided in a stand-alone EM&A Manual.

11.7 Conclusion

11.7.1.1 The baseline study, comprising desktop research and field evaluation, has identified thirteen (13) graded historic buildings within the assessment area of the Project but outside the Project Boundary. The five (5) Grade 2 historic buildings and eight (8) Grade 3 historic buildings are situated at a considerable distance from the Project Boundary. Therefore, no impact to them during the construction and operation phases. No declared monument, proposed monument, new item for grading assessment and Government historic site is located within the assessment area. Therefore, no impact is anticipated to the built heritage during the construction and operation phases. As no impact on built heritage is anticipated during the construction and operation phases, no mitigation measure is required.

11.7.1.2 For archaeology, Ngau Tam Mei SAI is partially located within the Project Boundary. The archaeological survey conducted at this stage indicates that the area in the vicinity of NTM-TP1 has experienced modern disturbance, with a lack of archaeological findings that suggests low archaeological significance. On the other hand, the existing concrete surface encountered at NTM-TP2 has hindered the identification of archaeological significance underlying the concrete surface of this area at the current stage.

11.7.1.3 Ngau Tam Mei SAI lies partially within the Project Boundary. The proposed works carried out within the SAI would only be temporary works that will not cause soil disturbance and therefore no impact is anticipated. Contractors will be required to submit method statements for approval by AMO and maintain photographic records of ground conditions, before, during and after works. With the control measures in place, the Project is expected to proceed with no impact to the Ngau Tam Mei SAI during the construction phase. Moreover, impact to archaeology during operation phase is not anticipated.

11.7.1.4 Pursuant to the A&MO (Cap. 53), the project proponent is required to inform AMO immediately in case of discovery of antiquities or supposed antiquities in the course of works, so that appropriate mitigation measures, if needed, can be formulated in a timely manner and implemented in agreement with and to the satisfaction of AMO.

11.8 Bibliography

Books

Fyfe, J. A et al. (2000). *The Quaternary Geology of Hong Kong*. Hong Kong: Civil Engineering Department.

Hong Kong Government. (1964). *Laws of Hong Kong. Appendix IV A Selection of Constitutional Documents, Conventions and Treaties*. Retrieved from https://oelawhk.lib.hku.hk/archive/files/87f64e08aedf20f07b7d8ac2132030c1.pdf

U.S.D. Antiquities and Monuments Section. (1987). *Survey on historical rural architecture in San Tin Area*. Hong Kong: Antiquities and Monuments Office.

劉智鵬、劉蜀永 (編) (2020) 。《方志中的古代香港- 《新安縣志》香港史料選》。香港：三聯書店（香港）有限公司。

黃佩佳（2017）。《香港本地風光·附新界百詠》。香港：商務印書館（香港）有限公司。

Historical Documents

司馬遷 (c.a. 91BC)。《史記》， 卷一百一十三 南越列傳 第五十三。北京：中華書局 (1959) 。

靳文謨修、鄧文蔚纂 (1688) 。《新安縣志》。在廣東省地方志辦公室編，《廣東歷代方志集成：廣州府部》（第二十六冊）[康熙]新安縣志 [嘉慶]新安縣志。廣東：嶺南美術出版社(2006)。

Reports

古物古蹟辦事處 (1997) 。《全港文物普查 1997 第一地區(元朗區)工作報告》。香港：古物古蹟辦事處檔案。

古物古蹟辦事處 (1999) 。《元朗牛潭尾主渠道第二期工程考古調查工作報告》。香港：古物古蹟辦事處檔案。

陳六霞、洪小麗 (1985)。田野工作報告 – 新田區總報告。

Aerial Photos

Lands Department. (1924). *1:14332, unknown flying height, H32-0013* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.

Lands Department. (1945). *1:12000, 20000 ft., 681_4-4137* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.

Lands Department. (1945). *1:12000, 20000ft., 681_4-3074* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.

Lands Department. (1945). *1:12000, 20000ft., 681_4-3115* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.

Lands Department. (1949). *1:4800, 8000ft., 81A_124-6029* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.

Lands Department. (1954). *1:25029, 29200 ft., V81A_550-0078* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.

Lands Department. (1954). *1:25029, 29200ft., V81A_550-0047R* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.

Lands Department. (1954). *1:25029, 29200ft., V81A_550-0076* [aerial photo]. Survey and Mapping Office, Lands Department

Lands Department. (1956). *1:10020, 16700 ft., F22_560-0205* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.

Lands Department. (1961). *1:10000, 30000ft., F41_625-0026* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.

Lands Department. (1961). *1:10000, 30000ft., F42_625-0020* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.

Lands Department. (1961). *1:10000, 30000ft., F42_625-0022* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.

Lands Department. (1961). *1:10000, 30000ft., F43_625-0019* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.

Lands Department. (1963). *1:1000, T2-SE-21D* [digital orthophoto]. Lands Department.

Lands Department. (1963). *1:27000, 13500 ft., V81A_857-0013R* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.

Lands Department. (1964). *1:25000, 12500ft., 1964-2788* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.

Lands Department. (1975). *1:25000, 12500ft., 11882R* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.

Lands Department. (1979). *1:8000, 4000ft., 26173* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.

Lands Department. (1988). *1:8000, 4000ft., A15814* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.

Lands Department. (1990). *1:4000, 2000 ft., A21941* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.

Lands Department. (1996). *1:8000, 4000 ft., A44200* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.

Lands Department. (2020). *1:10000, 6900ft., E093012* [aerial photo]. Lands Department.

Maps

Geotechnical Control Office. (1988). *Hong Kong Geological Survey Sheet 2*. Government of Hong Kong.

Great Britain. War Office. General Staff. Geographical Section & Great Britain. *Ordnance Survey. (1952). Hong Kong and New Territory, Sheet 10 San Tin (Fifth Edition)*. Retrieved from http://nla.gov.au/nla.obj-2975836020.

Lands Department. (1962). *1:1200, 91-SE-B [topographic map]*. Lands Department.

Lands Department. (1966). *1:4,800, Sht 92 [topographic map]*. Lands Department.

Lands Department. (1967). *1:4,800, Sht 75 [topographic map]*. Lands Department.

Websites

Antiquities Advisory Board. Historic Building Appraisal - General House – Main Building, Fung Kat Heung, Yuen Long. Retrieved from https://www.aab.gov.hk/filemanager/aab/common/historicbuilding/en/307_Appraisal_En.pdf

Antiquities Advisory Board. Historic Building Appraisal – Lau Village House. Retrieved from https://www.aab.gov.hk/filemanager/aab/common/historicbuilding/en/657_Appraisal_En.pdf

Civil Engineering and Development Department. Major Projects - Advance Site Formation and Engineering Infrastructure Works at Kwu Tung North and Fanling North New Development Area. Retrieved from https://www.cedd.gov.hk/eng/our-projects/major-projects/index-id-36.html

Development Bureau (2025). The New Development Areas – Introduction/Background. Retrieved from https://www.ktnfln-ndas.gov.hk/en/2-1-about_project.php

Drainage Services Department (2022). Shan Pui River / Kam Tin River. Retrieved from https://www.dsd.gov.hk/EcoDMS/EN/River_Channels/Shan_Pui_River.html#

History in Data Project website (Accessed on 17 March 2025) Hong Kong 1941. Retrieved from https://digital.lib.hkbu.edu.hk/1941hkbattle/en/research-team.php

Hong Kong e-Legislation. Cap. 499 Environmental Impact Assessment Ordinance. Retrieved from https://www.elegislation.gov.hk/hk/cap499

Water Supplies Department. Ngau Tam Mei Water Treatment Works. Retrieved from https://www.wsd.gov.hk/filemanager/en/share/pdf/NgauTamMeiTW-e.pdf

Newspapers

Novel Scheme – Proposed $200,000 Model Village (1925, April 16). The China Mail, p. 1.

《八鄉打石湖一帶 夜聞虎嘯 驚動軍警循聲往捕 通山搜索又無所得》 (1965 年 8 月 4 日)。華僑日報，第二張第一頁。

《錦田逢吉鄉 興建華盛頓新邨 下月十一日開幕 為新界遭受風災災民而建》 (1966 年 2 月 27 日)。華僑日報，第三張第三頁。